

Social Influence

Outline

Social Influence

1) Conformity
2) Compliance
3) Obedience to Authority

What Is Social Influence?

- Social influence
  - The many ways people affect one another, including changes in attitudes, beliefs, feelings, and behavior resulting from the comments, actions, or even the mere presence of others.



What Is Social Influence?



Examples of social influence?

What Is Social Influence?



What Is Social Influence?

Examples of social influence

- Fashion trends, peer pressure, social media influence, and so on





Social Influence: Conformity

- Conformity

  Changing one's behavior or beliefs in response to explicit or implicit pressure (real or imagined) from others.

Social Influence: Conformity

- The pressure to conform can be implicit.
  - e.g., you decide to toss out your loose-fitting jeans in favor of those with a tighter cut (or vice versa) simply because other people are doing so



- The pressure to conform can also be explicit.
  - e.g., members of a peer group encourage one another to play computer games



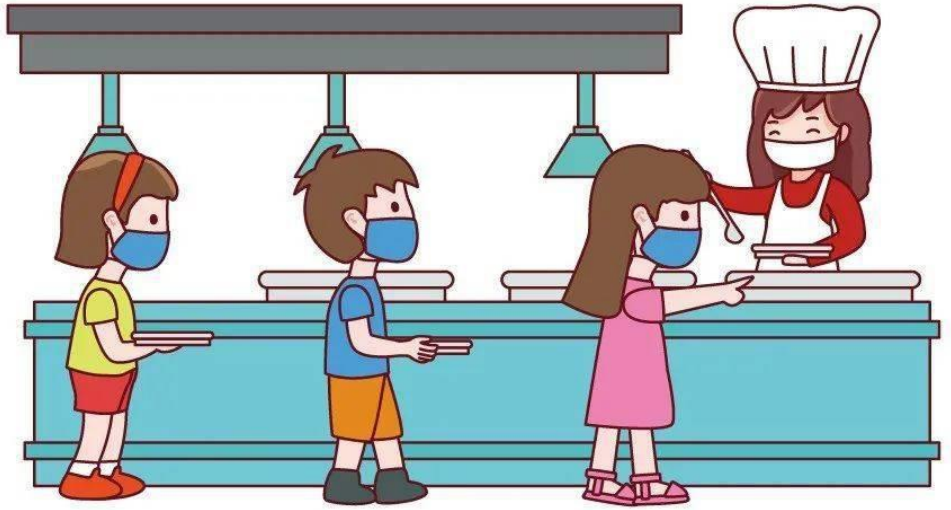
Social Influence: Conformity

Is conformity good or bad?

Is the tendency to go along with others a good thing or a bad thing?

Social Influence: Conformity

- Some types of conformity are bad.
- Some types of conformity are neither good nor bad.
- Some types of conformity are clearly beneficial.
  - To suppress anger
  - To form lines at canteen
  - Stay to the right side of the sidewalk



Conformity: Chameleon Effect



Conformity: Chameleon Effect

The nonconscious mimicry of the mannerisms of an interaction partner.



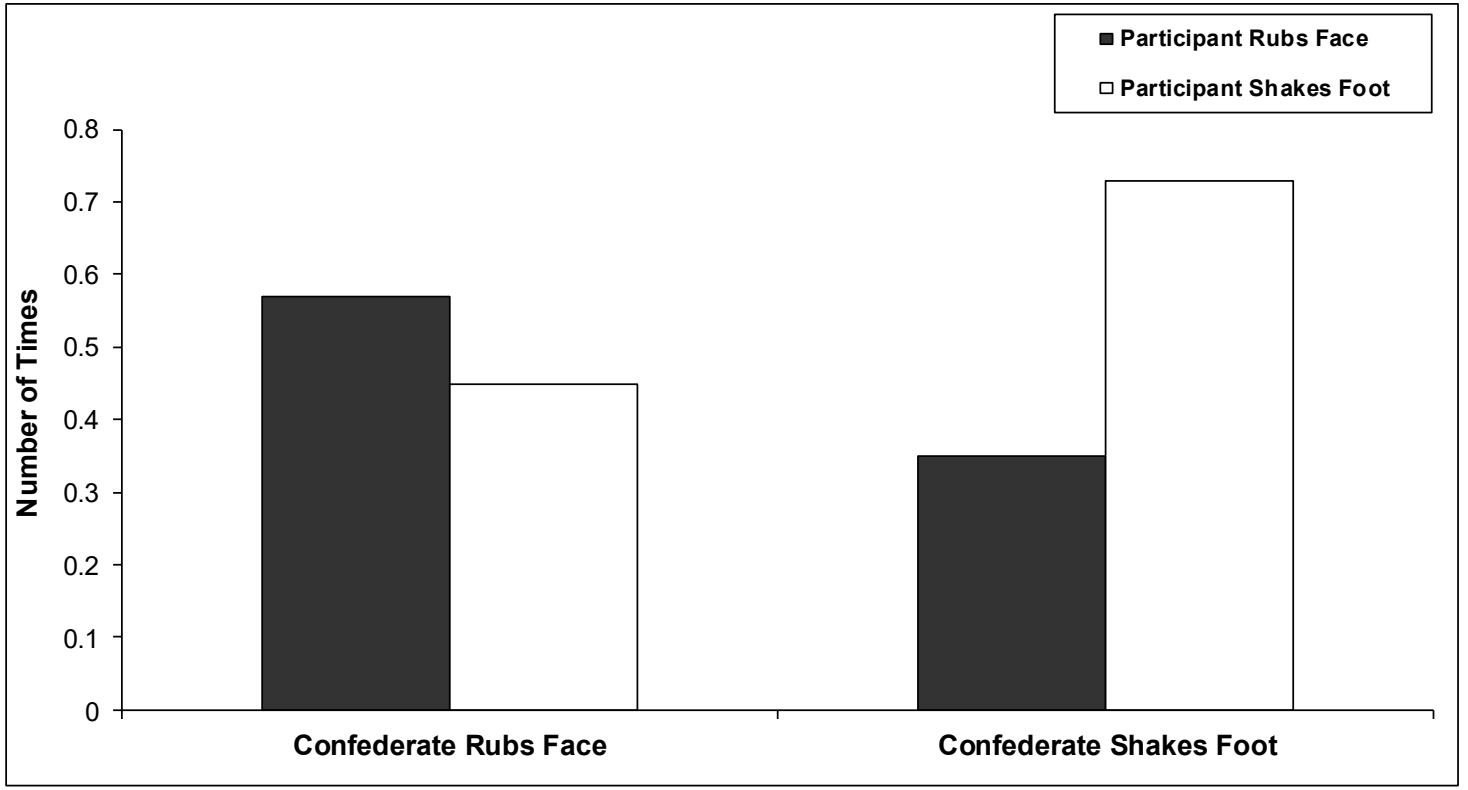
Conformity: Chameleon Effect

Chartrand & Bargh (1999)



Conformity: Chameleon Effect

Chartrand & Bargh (1999)



Conformity: Chameleon Effect

- *Does this behavior occur automatically? Consciously?*
- *Why do we mimic others?*

Conformity: Chameleon Effect

- The mere perception of another's behavior can automatically increase the likelihood of engaging in that behavior oneself. This is based on the fact that the brain regions responsible for perception overlap with those responsible for action.
- To facilitate smooth, gratifying interaction and to foster social connection.
  - People tend to like those who mimic them more than those who don't, even when they're unaware of being mimicked (Chartrand & Bargh, 1999).
  - People who have been mimicked tend to engage in more prosocial behavior immediately afterward (van Baaren et al., 2004).

Sherif's Conformity Experiment

Autokinetic Study (Sherif, 1936)

Sherif’s Conformity Experiment

Write it down.

Sherif’s Conformity Experiment

Write it down.

Sherif’s Conformity Experiment

Write it down.

Sherif’s Conformity Experiment

Submit your answer.

Sherif’s Conformity Experiment

Say it aloud.

Sherif’s Conformity Experiment

Say it aloud.

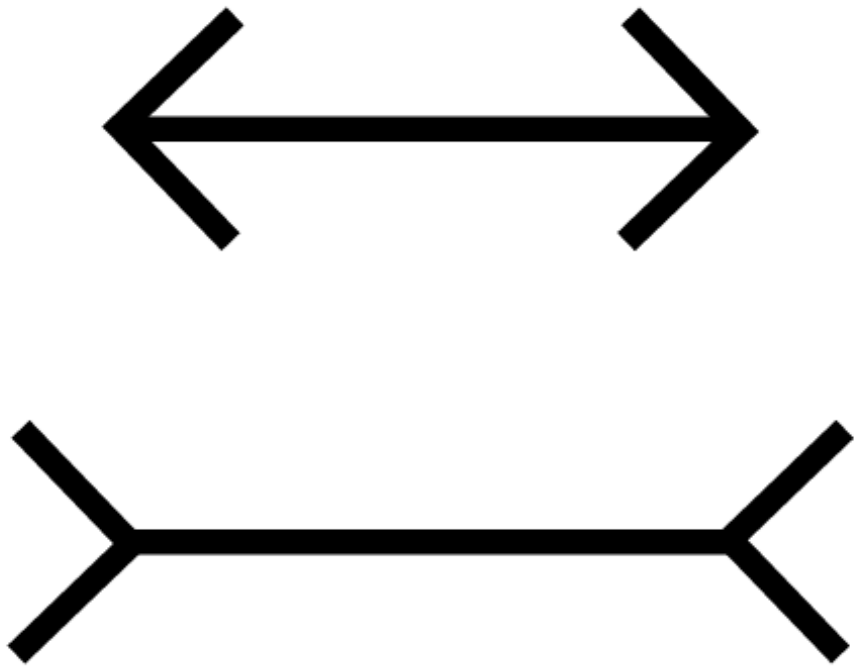
Sherif’s Conformity Experiment

Say it aloud.

Sherif's Conformity Experiment

The influence can be a bit more conscious.

Muzafer Sherif (1936) was interested in how groups influence the behavior of individuals by shaping how reality is perceived.



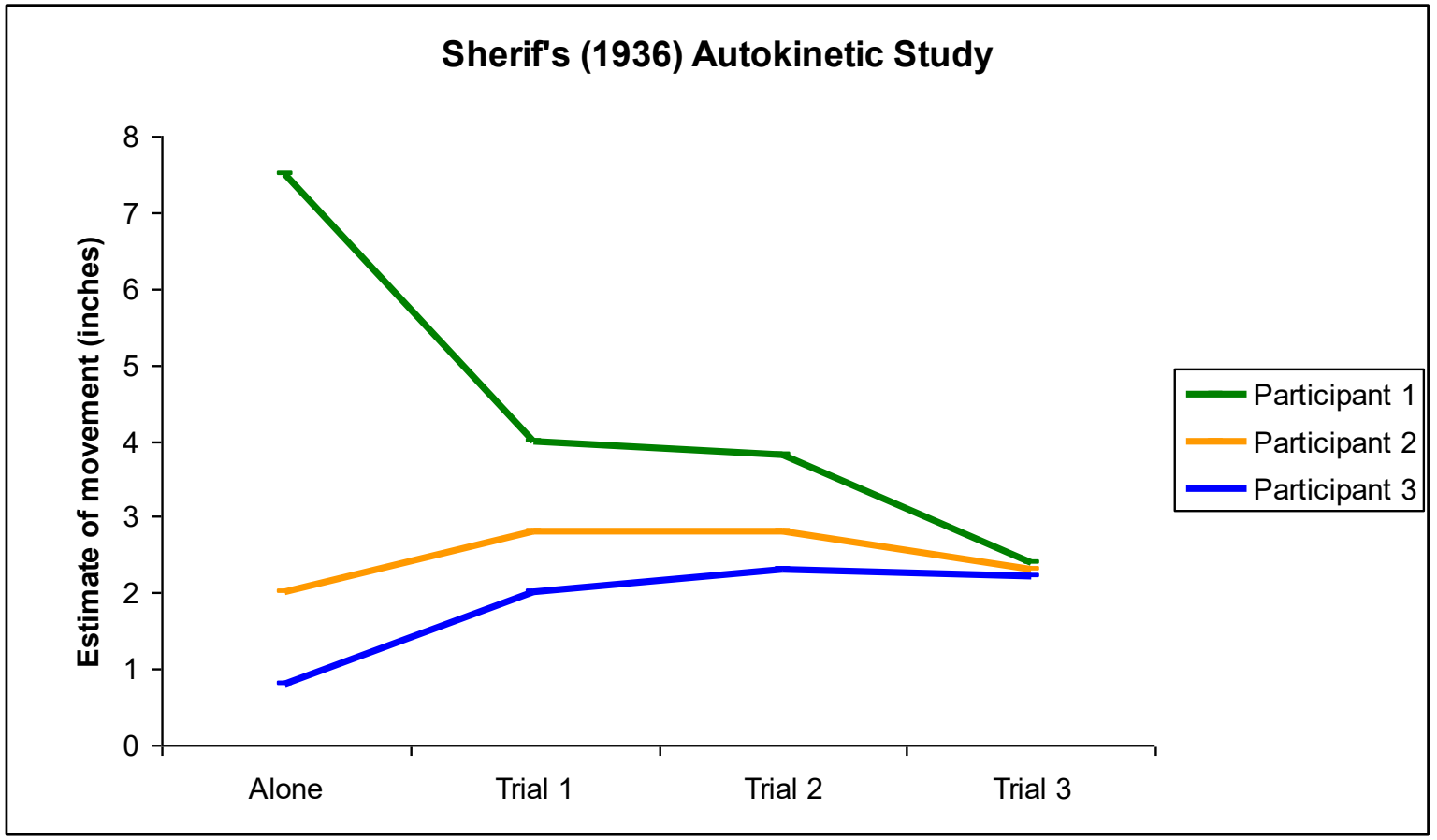
Müller-Lyer illusion

Sherif's Conformity Experiment

Sherif (1936)

- When participants were individually tested, their estimates on how far the light moved varied considerably (e.g., from 20cm to 80cm).
- The participants were then tested in groups of three. Sherif manipulated the composition of the group by putting together two people whose estimate of the light movement when alone was very similar, and one person whose estimate was very different. Each person in the group had to say aloud how far they thought the light had moved.

Sherif's Conformity Experiment



Sherif’s Conformity Experiment



Informational Social Influence

- We conform because we believe that others' interpretation of an ambiguous situation is more correct than ours and this interpretation will help us choose an appropriate course of action.
- We use others as a source of information about the world.
- We conform because we think this is the "right" way to act in this situation.

Informational Social Influence

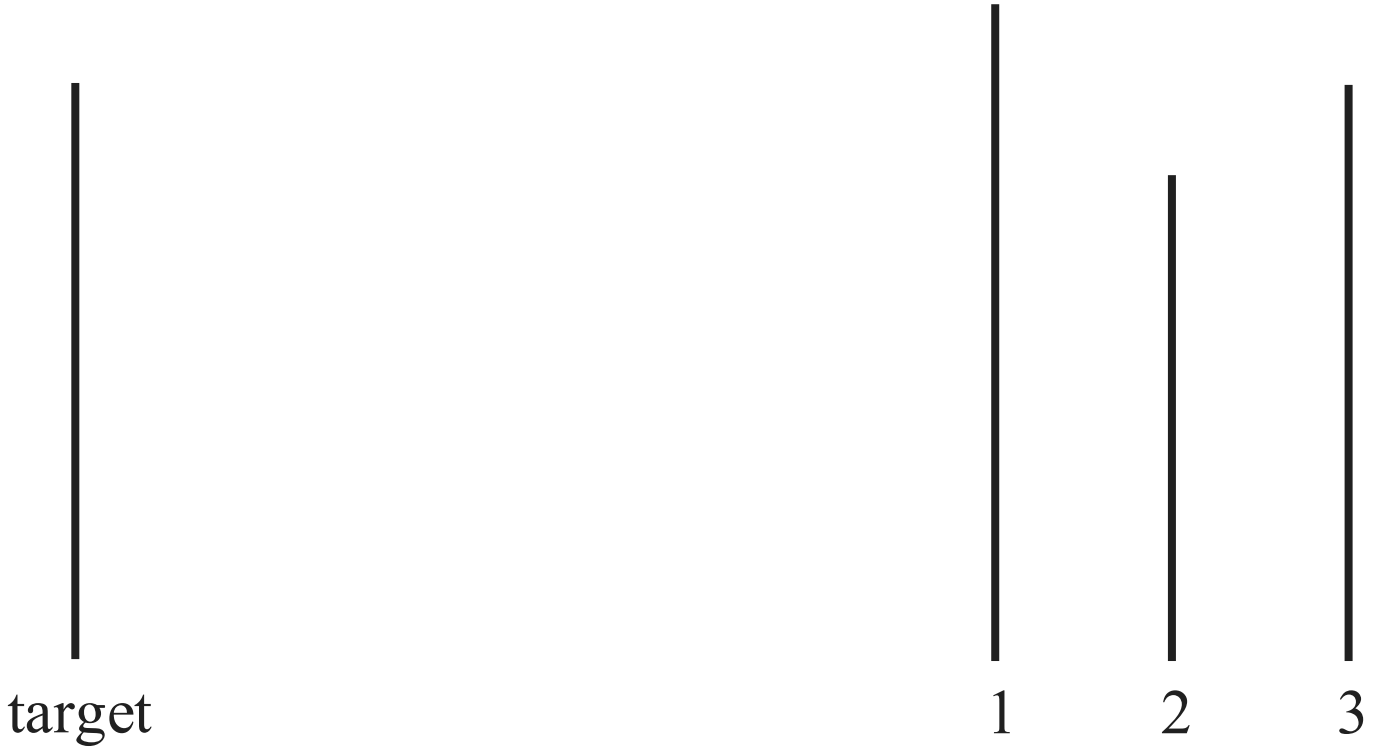
The reliance on other people's comments and actions as an indication of what's likely to be correct, proper, or effective (Cialdini & Goldstein, 2004; Deutsch & Gerard, 1955).

Asch's Conformity Experiment



Normative Social Influence and Asch's Conformity Experiment

Which line matches the target line?

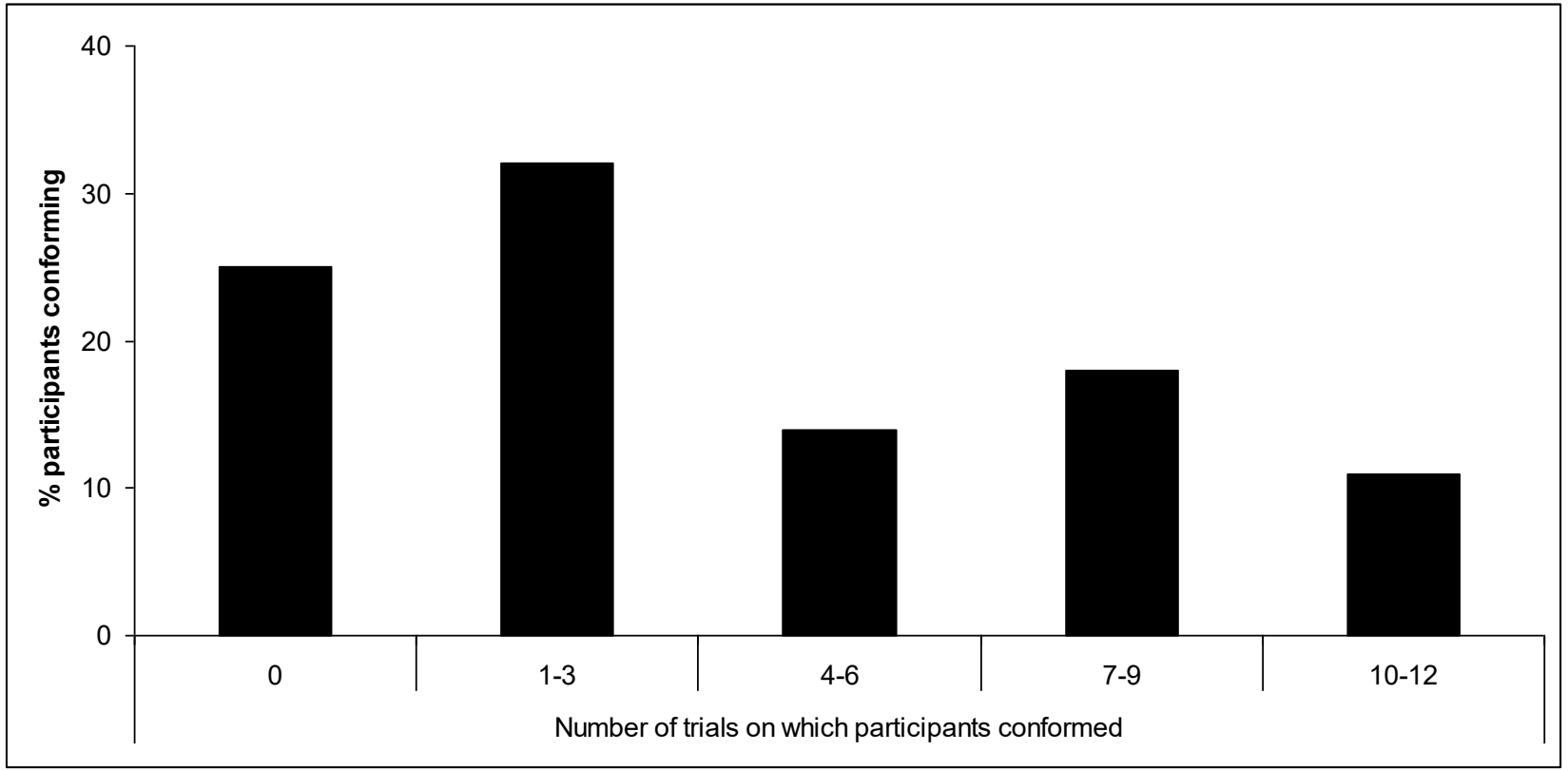


Asch's Conformity Experiment

Social Pressure Study (Asch, 1951)



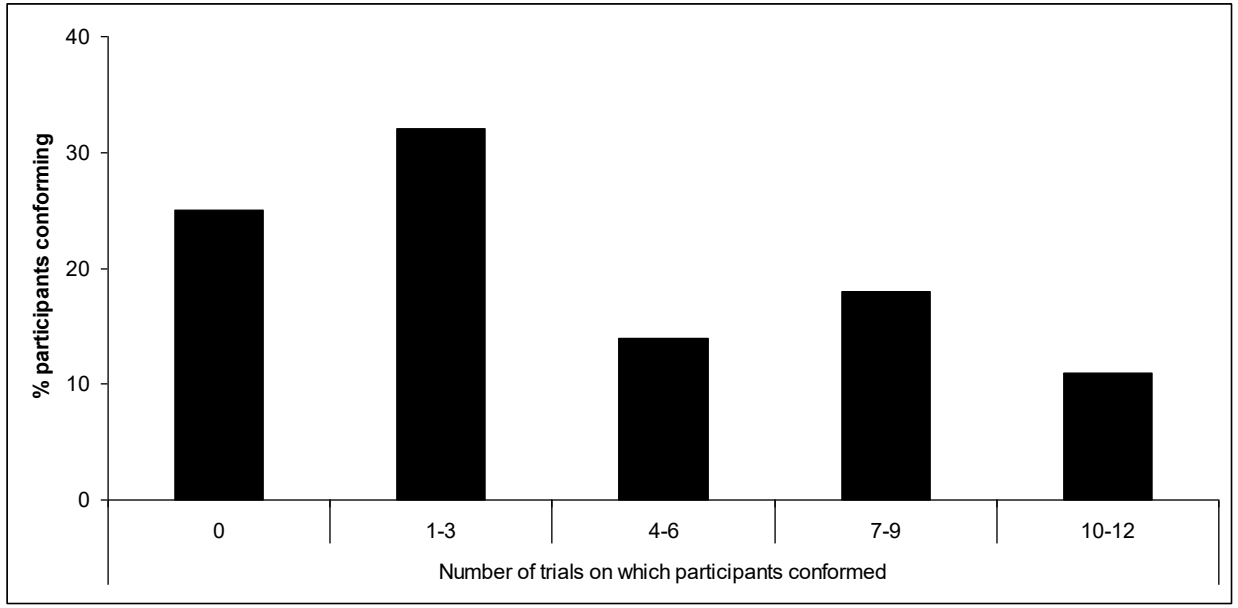
Normative Social Influence and Asch's Conformity Experiment



Questions?

What percentage of participants conformed to the group response at least once even though they knew it was wrong?

A. 25%
B. 50%
C. 75%
D. 100%



Normative Social Influence

The influence of other people that comes from the desire to avoid their disapproval and other social sanctions (ridicule, barbs, ostracism).

Normative Social Influence

Normative social influence leads to public compliance but not necessarily private acceptance.

- People may publicly agree with the group opinion in order to avoid social disapproval but privately believe something different.

Factors Affecting Conformity Pressure



Will the minority influence the majority?

Minority Influence Majority

- Consistent minority opinion
- Through informational social influence rather than normative social influence





Compliance

Compliance

Responding favorably to an explicit request by another person.

- Example: agreeing to do someone a favor.





What strategies can you use to get others to agree to your requests?

Compliance

- Reason-Based Approach



- Emotion-Based Approach



- Norm-Based Approach



Reason-Based Approaches: Reciprocity Norms

- Norm of reciprocity
  - A norm dictating that people should provide benefits to those who benefit them.



Even when given something small, we may feel obligated by a later request.
- Why it works: feeling obligated (“You gave to me, so I give to you.”)

Reason-Based Approaches: Reciprocal Concessions

- Reciprocal concessions technique (door-in-the-face technique)
  - A compliance approach that involves asking someone for a very large favor that will certainly be refused and then following that request with one for a smaller favor (which tends to be seen as a concession the target feels compelled to honor).



When asked to buy a $5 raffle ticket, the person refuses. Then the person is asked to buy a $1 candy bar and agrees (even though the person doesn't like chocolate that much).

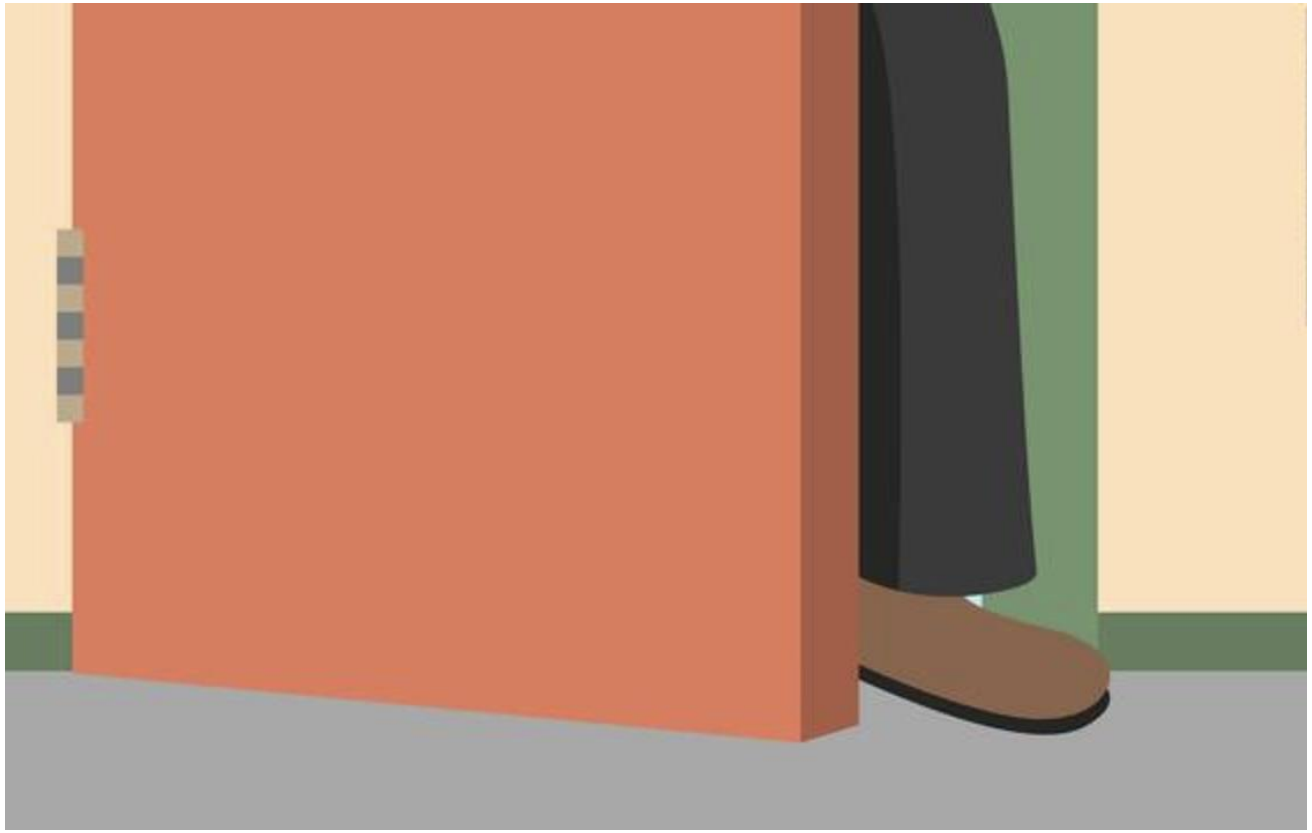
Reason-Based Approaches: Reciprocal Concessions

Why it works: reciprocal concession

"You compromised with me, so I'll compromise with you."

Reason-Based Approaches: Foot-in-the-Door Technique

- Foot-in-the-door technique



Reason-Based Approaches: Foot-in-the-Door Technique

- Foot-in-the-door technique
  - A compliance approach that involves making an initial small request with which nearly everyone complies, followed by a larger request involving the real behavior of interest.



Reason-Based Approaches: Foot-in-the-Door Technique

Why it works?

Getting someone started on something small often leads to a change in that person's self-image. That person then has a reason for agreeing to the subsequent, larger request, "It's just who I am."

Emotion-Based Approaches

- Both positive and (some) negative moods can increase rates of compliance.



Emotion-Based Approaches

- Positive moods
  - Our mood colors how we interpret events.
    - We are more likely to view requests for favors as less intrusive and less threatening when we're in a good mood.
  - Mood maintenance
    - It feels good to say yes.
    - People want to maintain a positive mood so they agree more easily.

Emotion-Based Approaches: Negative Moods

- Negative moods
  - Negative state relief hypothesis
    - The idea that people engage in certain actions, such as agreeing to a request, to relieve their negative feelings and feel better about themselves.

Emotion-Based Approaches: Guilt

- Guilt
  - Social psychologists have demonstrated a strong positive association between guilt and compliance.
  - May feel more obligated to help someone if we feel guilty.
  - Better to ask for a donation before someone confesses their sins than afterward.

Norm-Based Approaches

- Effective norm-based appeals
  - Letting people know what others are doing also can be used to advance the public good.



Using Norms to Conserve Energy

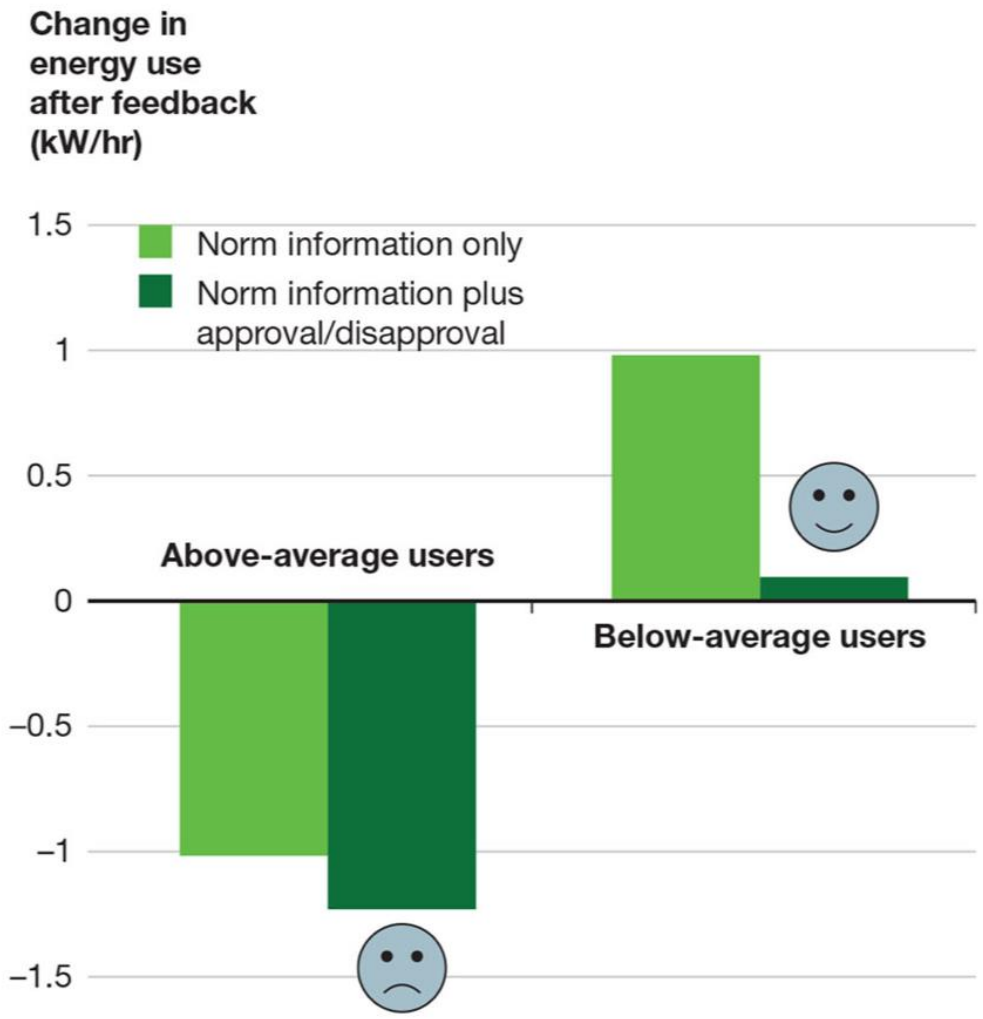


FIGURE 9.8
USING NORMS TO CONSERVE ENERGY
Source: Adapted from Schultz et al., 2007.

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Descriptive and Prescriptive Norms

- Descriptive norms
  - The behavior exhibited by most people in a given context
- Prescriptive norms
  - The way a person is supposed to behave in a given context; also called injunctive norm



Obedience



Social Influence: Obedience

- Obedience
  - In an unequal power relationship, submitting to the demands of the person in authority

Following the orders of a police officer



Obedience: Milgram's (1963) Study



Obedience: Milgram's (1963) Study

Video on Milgram Studies
https://www.bilibili.com/video/BV1L4411975G/?spm_id_from=333.788.recommend_more_video.0

Video on Milgram Studies (Full Documentary)
https://www.bilibili.com/video/BV1us411f7TR/?spm_id_from=333.788.recommend_more_video.2

Obedience: Milgram's (1963) Study

- "Teachers" believe they are delivering shocks to a "learner" (appear to be randomly assigned to the roles).
- Every time the learner gets an answer wrong, he gets a shock that increases in intensity.
- Strongly encouraged by the experimenter to continue, even when the "learner" protests.

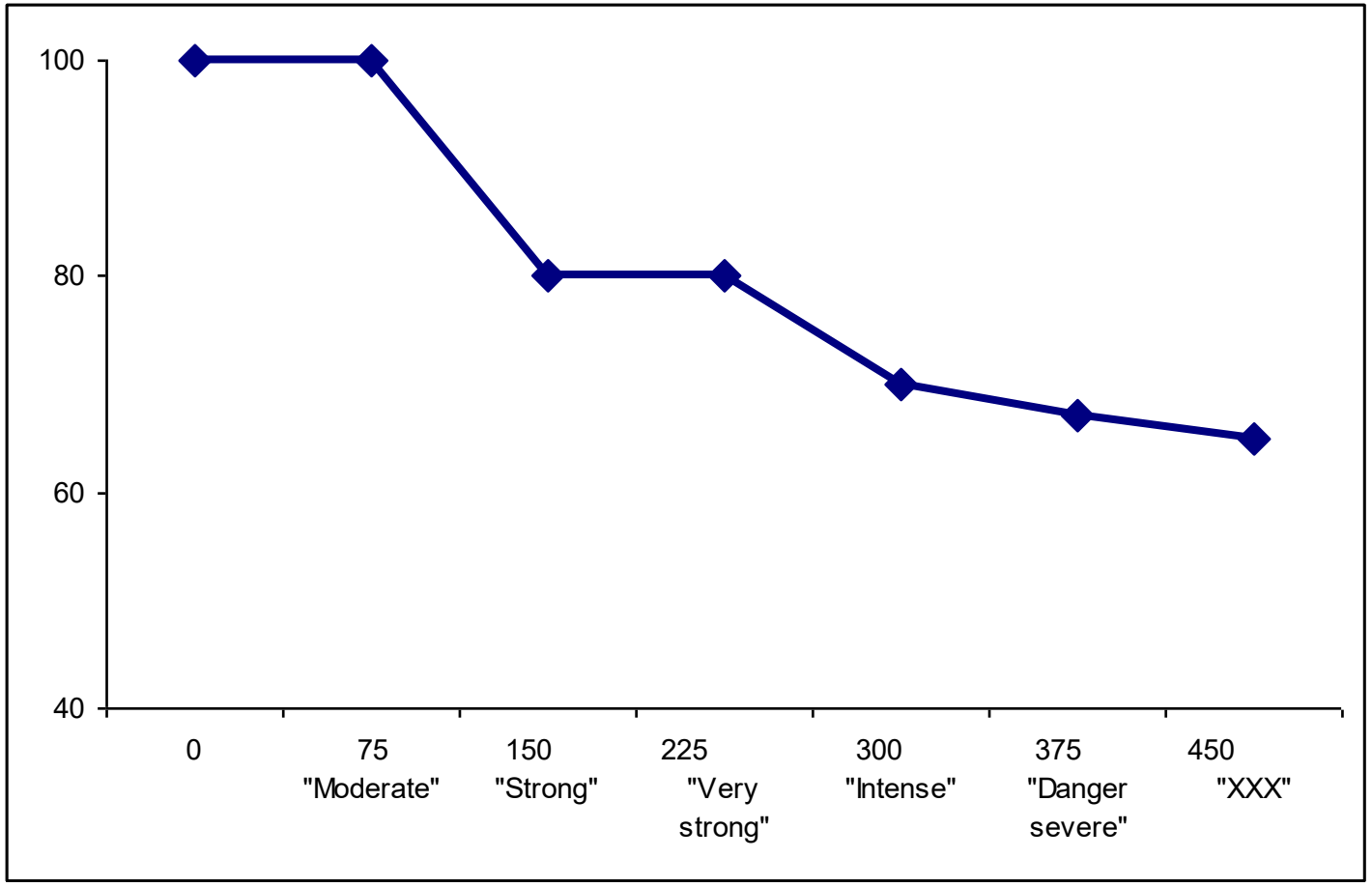
Obedience: Milgram's (1963) Study

Strongly encouraged by the experimenter to continue, even when the "learner" protests.

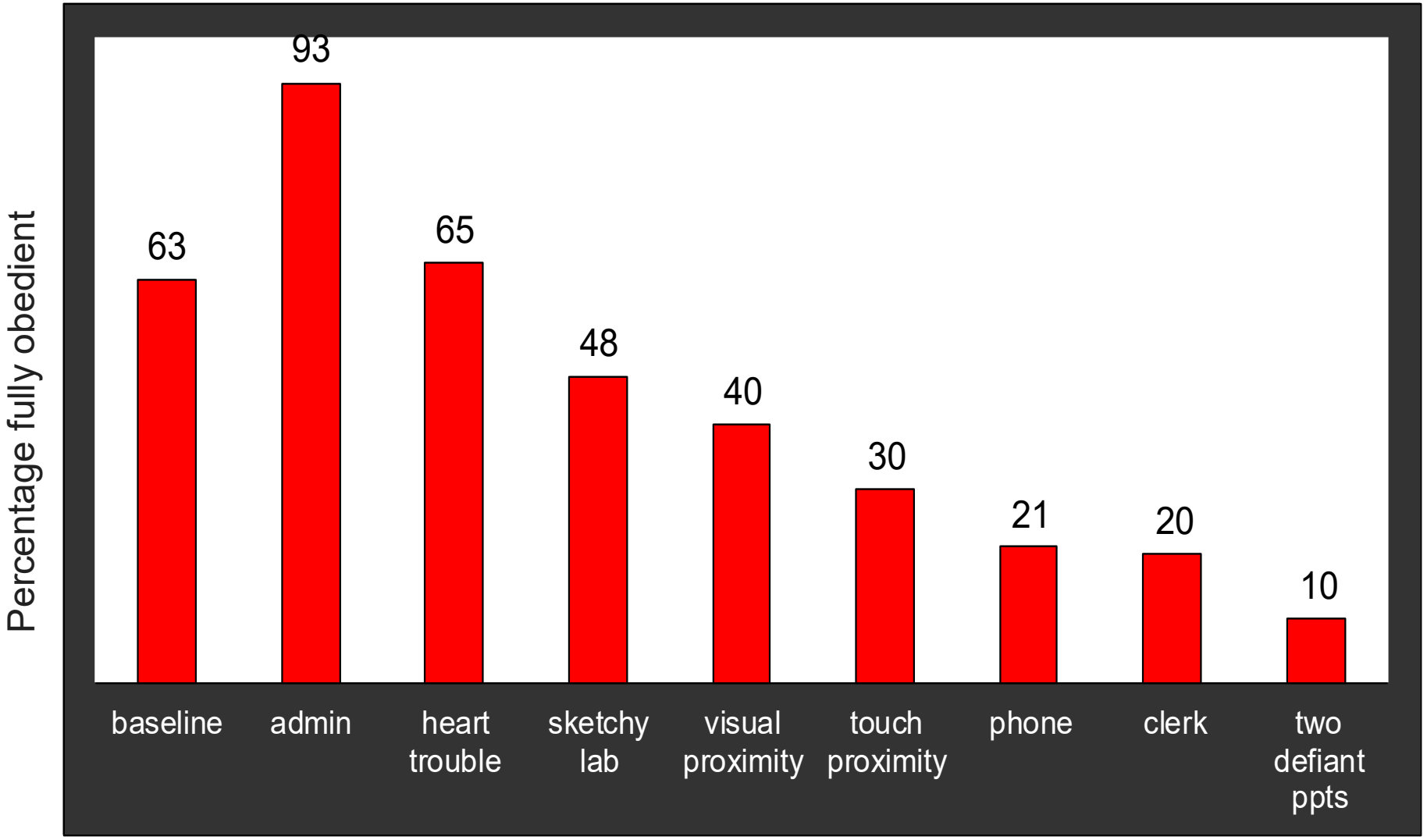
- **Normative social influence** – He says, "It is absolutely essential that you continue" (You think "… I did commit to doing this study…what will he think of me if I mess up his study now?")

- **Informational social influence** – Because the situation is ambiguous/novel, we are unsure, and so we look to the expert/the experimenter (You think "… he must know what he is doing")

Obedience: Milgram's (1963) Study



Obedience Across Studies



Obedience: Milgram's (1963) Study

1. Emotional Distance of the Victim (learner) from the Subject (teacher)
   - "Proximity" (learner in same room, protests now visible)
   - "Touch Proximity" (must force hand of learner onto shock plate)
2. Closeness of the Authority
   - "Authority Remote" (experimenter leaves, gives orders by phone)
3. Legitimacy of the Authority
   - Sketchy lab (Research Associates of Bridgeport)
   - "Clerk Commands" (experimenter turns over to subjects, leaves; 'clerk' decides shocks will increase for each wrong answer)
4. Group influence
   - "Confederates Rebel" ('subject' reading questions and 'subject' recording answers quit)

Obedience: Milgram's (1963) Study

Explanations (other than normative and informational influences) for why people obeyed:

- We are socialized to obey.
- Increased in small increments (foot-in-the-door technique). Self-justification.
- Hard to say no to authority figure; hard to face and challenge situational norms.
- On automatic pilot to "obey the experimenter." We may adhere to norms in mindless ways. Fast-pace doesn't allow for much thought.
- Not evil people but bad situation.

Stanford Prison Study

Zimbardo (1971)
Personality versus Situation

Whether the situation defined guards' brutality and behaviors or whether it was related to the personality of people who took on those roles?



Stanford Prison Study

Social Role

Shared expectations by group members about how particular people in the group ought to behave.

- Zimbardo randomly assigned university students to role-play being either guards or prisoners.
  - Guards were given uniforms, whistles, and clubs and were told to enforce the rules.
  - Prisoners were given uniforms and locked in cells.

Stanford Prison Study



Planned to run for 2 weeks, stopped after 6 days because of excessive hostility of guards and mental/physical deterioration of prisoners.

Stanford Prison Study



Stanford Prison Study

Video on Stanford Prison Study
https://www.bilibili.com/video/BV1dF411Y7Wd?spm_id_from=333.337.search-card.all.click

Interview with Zimbardo
https://www.bilibili.com/video/BV1pS4y1G7cD?spm_id_from=333.337.search-card.all.click

Full documentary
https://www.bilibili.com/video/BV11b41147wW?spm_id_from=333.337.search-card.all.click

Deindividuation

The loosening of normal constraints on behavior when people are in a group, leading to an increase in impulsive (and deviant) acts.

Groups can:

- make people feel less accountable for their actions (e.g., soccer hooligans)
- decrease self-awareness
- make people more likely to obey group norms

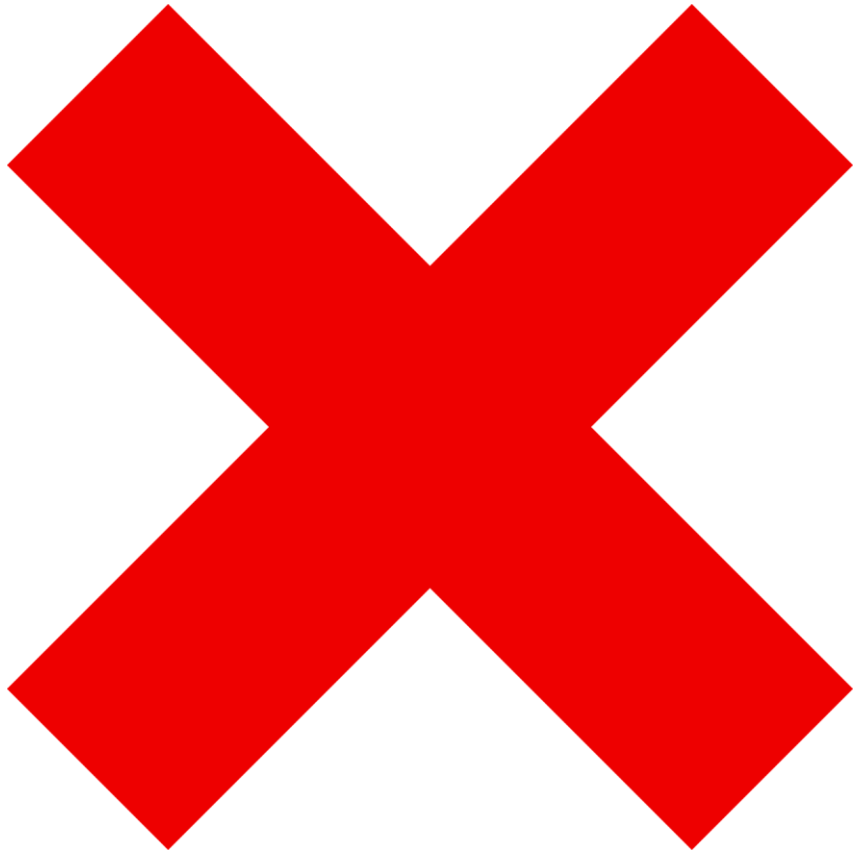
Questions?

How did Zimbardo try to deindividuate his participants?

A. sunglasses
B. no names but numbers
C. clothing, hats, uniforms
D. roles
E. all of the above

Replication and Other Issues with the Stanford Prison Study

- Haslam and Reicher (2006) failed to replicate. Far from breaking down, prisoners banded together and won extra privileges from guards, who became increasingly passive.



Replication and Other Issues with the Stanford Prison Study

- Some scholars have argued that it wasn't an experiment at all — "it was a happening."
  - What were main dependent variables — emotional upset of prisoners? abusiveness of guards? How measured?
- Guards were coached to be abusive (Demand Characteristics) — did not happen on own. If they were not abusive enough, they were told to step it up.
- Prisoners were faking it. Several prisoners wanted to stop and were told not possible – so they faked distress to end it.
- Article not published in scientific journal but published in The New York Times magazine – Not peer reviewed.

Deindividuation and Social Norms

Johnson and Downing's (1979)

Procedure: A verbal learning experiment.

- The subject is the teacher.
- After each error, the subject can choose to increase or decrease the level of shock to learner (+3, +2, +1, -1, -2, -3)

Deindividuation and Social Norms

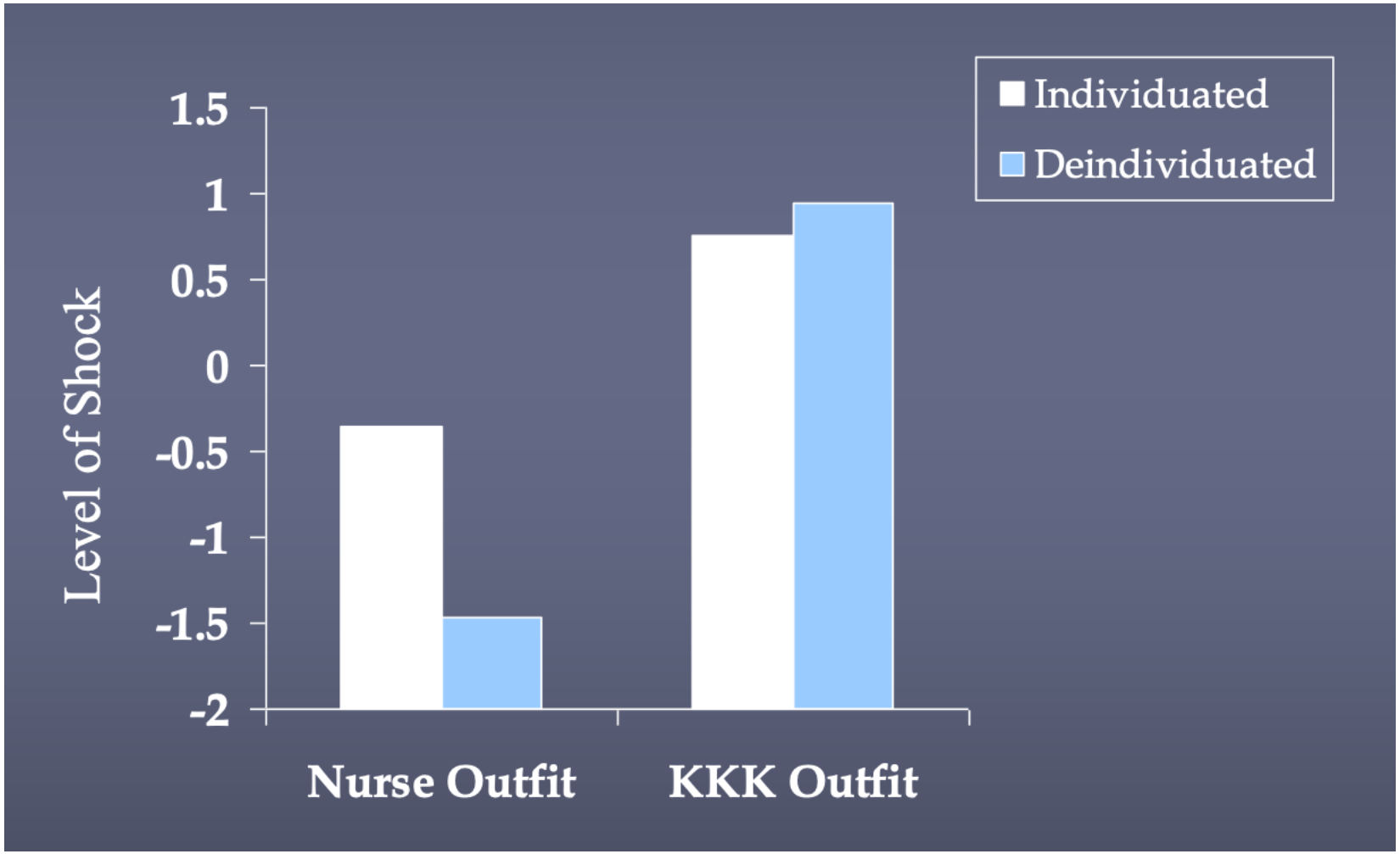
Two Independent variables:

- Social cues

  Everyone is asked to wear white outfits.
  - Prosocial cues – asked to put on nurses outfits
  - Anti-social cues – asked to put on KKK outfit

- Deindividuation
  - Told no way to identify who gave what shocks and no name tags
  - Told other group members could see their selection of shock levels and wore name tags

Deindividuation and Social Norms



Questions?

What was the dependent variable in this study?

A. the type of outfit the participant wore
B. the identifiability of the participant and his/her behavior (shocks)
C. the intensity of the shocks given to the learner
D. the role of participant as learner or teacher



Resisting Social Pressure

Resisting Social Pressure

- **Reactance** (Brehm & Brehm, 1981)
  An attempt to restore one's sense of freedom
- **Flexible Correction Model** (Wegener & Petty, 1997)
  Based on our naïve theories of influence, we correct for:
  - The direction of perceived influence
  - The extent of perceived influence

Flexible Correction Model

Wegener & Petty (1997)

Please write an essay about Donald Trump.

1) But … first I want to tell you all the positive things I know about Trump (loves his family, business experience, resilient).
2) But … first I want to tell you all the negative things I know about Trump (he lies, he's racist/sexist, he's ill-informed).

How do you think this initial context will influence your essays? How much do you think these initial contexts will influence your essays?

Mood and Life Satisfaction

Schwarz & Clore, 1983

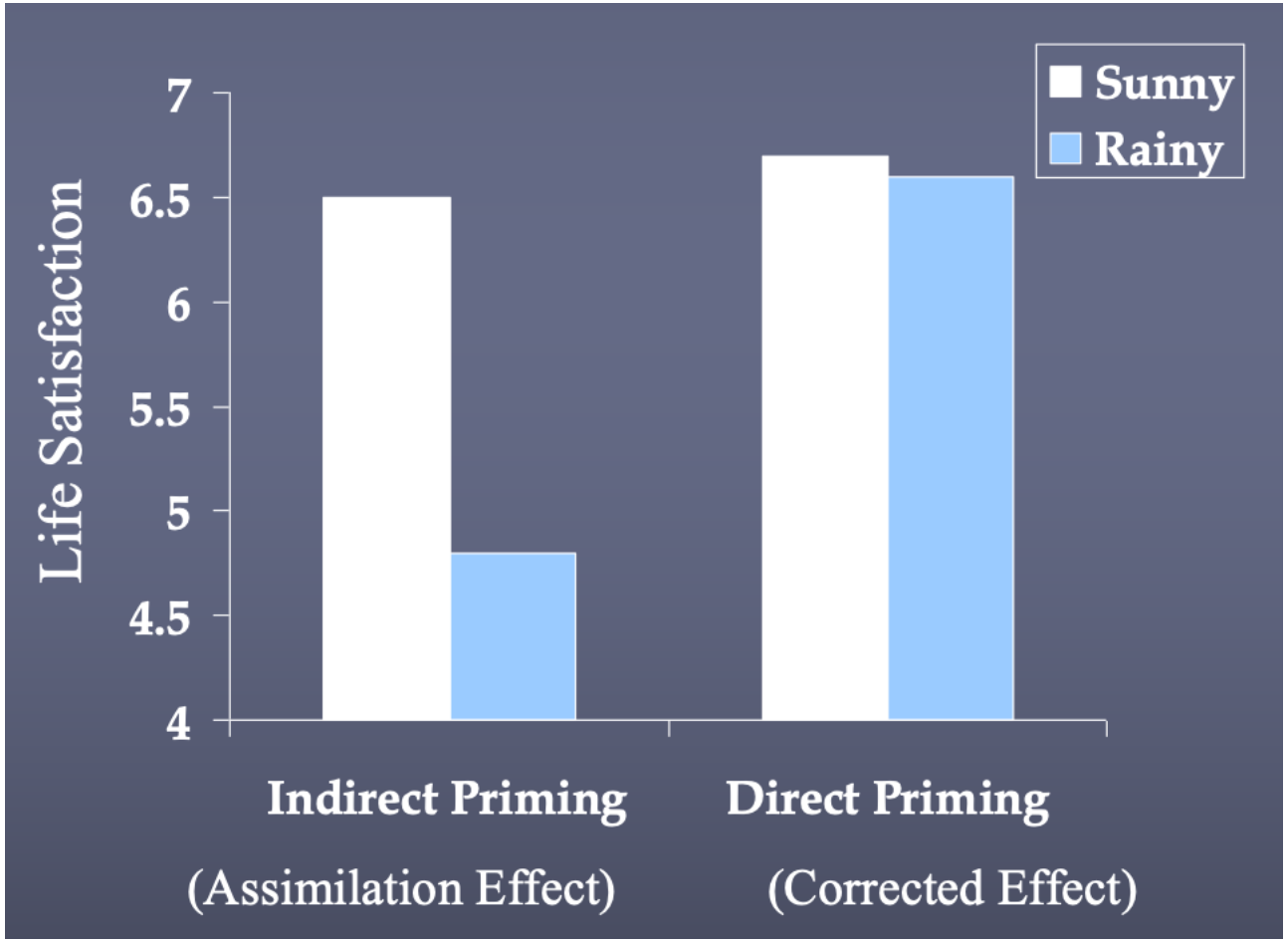
- Procedure: Telephone survey
  - 2 Independent Variables:
    - Mood:
      - Sunny Days
      - Rainy Days
    - Priming:
      - Direct: This study is about measuring the effects of weather on mood
      - Indirect: How is the weather there?
  - Dependent Variable:
    - Judgment: How satisfied are you with your life?





Mood and Life Satisfaction

- In general, how might your mood influence your ratings of life satisfaction?
  — Assimilation Effects
- When would you correct for this effect?



Context and Evaluations of Kansas

Petty & Wegner, 1993

- Procedure: Telephone survey
  - 2 Independent Variables:
    - Location: Rate how much you like the following location.
      - ❑ Dream vacation: Hawaii
      - ❑ Neutral vacation: Minneapolis
    - Instructions:
      - ❑ No Instructions
      - ❑ Correction Instructions: Do not let your ratings be influenced by initial location
  - Dependent Variable:
    - Judgment: How would you like to spend 2 weeks vacation in Kansas?

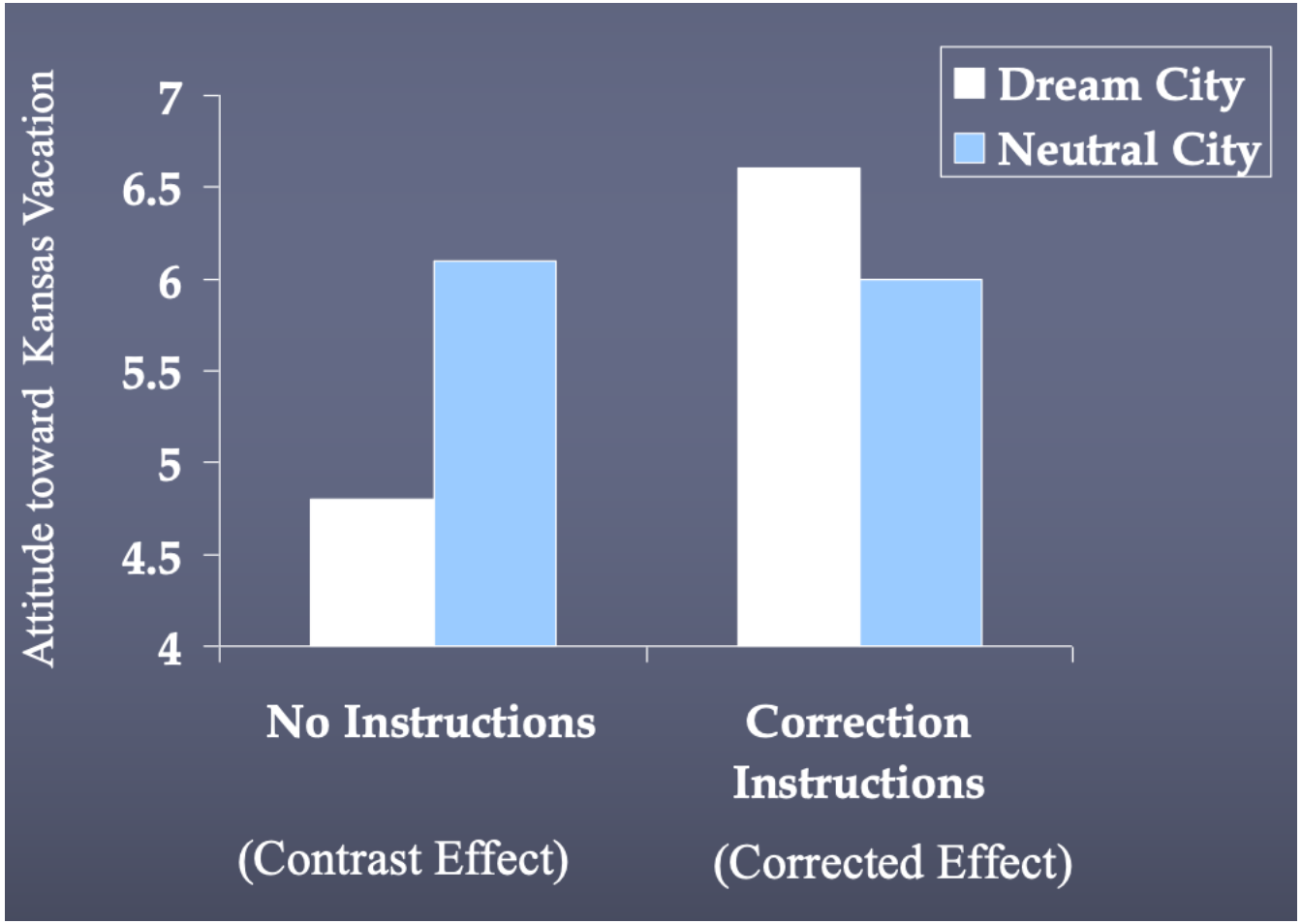




Context and Evaluations of Kansas

- In general, how might thinking about an initial vacation destination influence your ratings of Kansas City?
  — Contrast Effects

- When would you correct for this effect?



Flexible Correction Model

Based on our naïve theories of influence, we correct for:

- The direction of perceived influence
  - either assimilation or contrast effects
- Extent of perceived influence



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